Week - 8 AI Digest
AI Agents

Student Name: Harshavardhan Tumma
Construction & Facilities Engineering
University of North Carolina at Charlotte

Article Publication Date : December 29, 2025
Article Number : 21
Title & link of the Article : AI agents arrived in 2025 – here's what happened and the challenges ahead in 2026

Screenshot of the Headline

Edition: United States | Donate | Newsletters | Become an author | Sign up as a reader | Sign in

THE CONVERSATION
Academic rigor, journalistic flair

Search analysis, research, academics...

Arts + Culture | Economy | Education | Environment + Energy | Ethics + Religion | Health | Politics + Society | Science + Tech | World | Podcasts | Local

AI agents arrived in 2025 – here's what happened and the challenges ahead in 2026

Published: December 29, 2025 10:35am EST

AI agents have emerged from the lab, bringing promise and peril. tadamichi/iStock via Getty Images

In artificial intelligence, 2025 marked a decisive shift. Systems once confined to research labs and prototypes began to appear as everyday tools. At the center of

Author

Thomas Şerban von Davier

Main Findings and Arguments

- AI agents transitioned from academic research to practical, everyday infrastructure in 2025, representing a fundamental shift from text-generation to autonomous action.
- Critical breakthroughs: Anthropic's Model Context Protocol, DeepSeek-R1 market disruption, and Google's Agent2Agent protocol were established as open standards through Linux Foundation donation.
- Real-world applications emerged rapidly across agentic browsers (Perplexity Comet, OpenAI GPT Atlas), coding agents (GitHub Copilot, Cursor), and workflow builders democratizing agent creation.
- Economic transformation: 92% cost reduction ($30 to $0.10-2.50 per million tokens) made agents economically viable. Market projected to grow 30-fold from $7.92B (2025) to $236B (2034).
- Critical risks identified: Claude Code agent misused for cyberattacks, governance gap (70% use agents but <10% can govern them), and 144 non-human identities per employee.

Broader Implications & Construction Industry Relevance

- Economic restructuring and workforce displacement requiring retraining
- Democratic governance threats due to governance gaps
- Inequality in benefit distribution across society
- Concentration of AI power in few companies poses geopolitical risks
- Urgent need for immediate policy response

Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

- Project management automation and resource optimization
- Enhanced safety monitoring and hazard prediction
- Predictive delay analysis and timeline optimization
- Streamlined stakeholder communication
- Requirement: Governance frameworks and worker retraining must precede deployment

UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA CHARLOTTE

Thank You